

People

About 92 per cent of the people are Germans. Turks make up the largest minority group of more than 2,000,000, having gone to Germany in the 1960s to boost the labour force. Since 1990, many immigrants have arrived from eastern Europe. Some racial discrimination has caused social tension.



235 per sq km
(609 per sq mile)



87% 13%
Urban Rural



Society

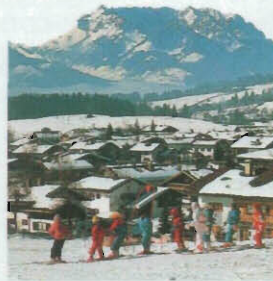
German society prides itself on equal opportunities and a comprehensive social welfare system, with free education and healthcare. Germans are environmentally aware, and the influence of the Green Party has led to strict anti-pollution policies.

Leisure

The Germans love sports and outdoor activities. Many enjoy hiking and cycling in the countryside, or canoeing and sailing on the lakes and rivers. In winter, skiing and skating are popular. Germans also excel at football, tennis, and motor-racing.

Skiing

Snow-covered slopes in the Bavarian Alps provide Germans with plenty of opportunities to practise their skiing. Children begin the sport early. Many people also travel to nearby French and Swiss ski resorts.



Football

The German national team has won the World Cup three times, as well as the Euro '96 cup against the Czech Republic. Association football, or soccer, is the most popular sport in Germany both for players and spectators, and there are many clubs.

Farming

Only three per cent of Germany's labour force work on the land, yet the country grows about two-thirds of all the food it needs. Crops include cereals, potatoes, and other vegetables. Pigs and cattle are reared.



Wheat



Sugar beet

Grapes



Crops

Germany's chief cereal crops are barley, oats, rye, and wheat. Sugar beet for refining to produce sugar is also widely grown. Grapes grow best in the areas bordering the Rhine and Moselle rivers, and are used for producing Germany's world-famous white wines.



Dairy

The lush green pastures of Germany's Allgäu valley, in the Alps, are ideal for grazing dairy cattle for milk, butter, and cheese.

Food

German people enjoy traditional smoked sausages, smoked meats and cheese, *sauerkraut* (pickled cabbage), and smoked and pickled fish, usually eaten with good, sourdough bread and a glass of cold beer. They also make tasty soups, sweet and savoury dumplings, and enjoy afternoon *Kaffee und Kuchen*, coffee with cakes.



Transport

Germany has an excellent transport system with 14 international airports, major sea ports in Hamburg and Bremen, and a highly efficient rail and road network. Canals and rivers, such as the Rhine and Ruhr, carry as much freight as the roads.

Inland waterways

Many of Germany's rivers are linked by canals, like the Danube-Main canal, creating an extensive network that makes long-distance freight transport practical.



Autobahns

Germany has Europe's most elaborate motorway network stretching almost 11,400 km (7,084 miles), with no speed limit. The first *Autobahn* was built in the 1930s for military use.

Industry

Over the last 50 years, Germany has become one of the world's leading industrial nations, and is an important manufacturer of cars, trucks, electrical goods, ships, and chemicals. The heart of German industry lies in the Ruhr, once a major coal-producing region.



Cars

Germany is one of the world's largest car manufacturers. Volkswagen is an internationally renowned make. Other famous brands are BMW, Mercedes-Benz, and Porsche.



Shipbuilding

Hamburg, Germany's largest port on the mouth of the Elbe river, has a long tradition of shipbuilding, as has Bremen on the mouth of the River Weser. Germany leads the rest of Europe in shipbuilding, and ranks highly in the world.



Precision work

Electronic devices such as calculators, computers, and electrical equipment such as this drill, form a large part of Germany's industrial output. The country also produces precision optical equipment.

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